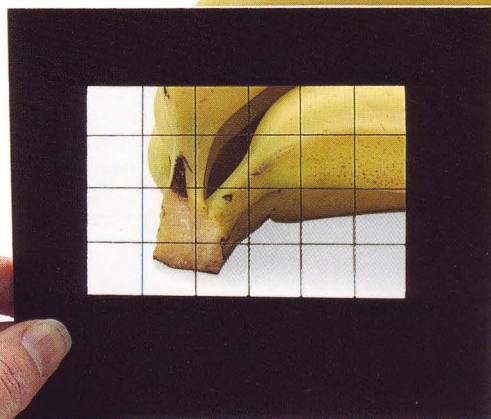


CREATING A COMPOSITION



Viewfinder

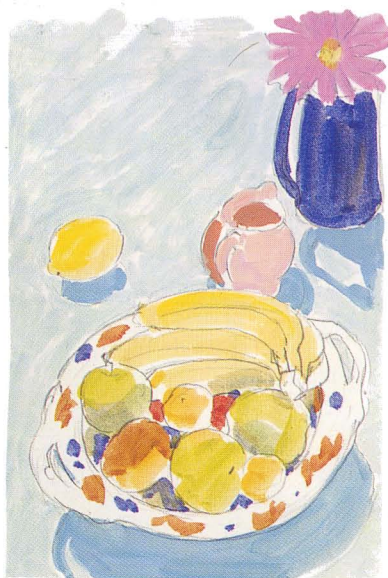
Cut a window in a piece of posterboard and use it to look for the best composition.

COMPOSITION IS A TERM THAT DESCRIBES the organization of space in a picture – ordering shapes, forms, and colors in a way that is appropriate to the meaning of the image. When you are putting a composition together, look for balance and a sense of appropriateness, trusting your intuition. If you are working from life, look at the image through a viewfinder. Move it closer to and then farther away from the image until you see the composition you want. If you are working from a photograph, try cropping areas of the image with small strips of paper.



Looking for a composition

The most interesting composition is usually one that gives an image a fresh slant so that you perceive it in a new way. Arrange a still-life composition on a table top, and then sketch it from as many different angles as you can think of. Try to be adventurous, closing right in on the still-life or sketching just a few elements of the composition.



Visual impact

As you sketch, look for the way colored objects react with each other to create a subtle harmony or a vibrant contrast. You may want to rearrange objects to achieve a better visual impact.

